

DIRECTV

DIRECTV EVERYWHERE · 2012–2013

5M+ Downloads at Launch

Hollywood Reporter · Engadget · MIT Tech Review

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DIRECTV Everywhere: Turning a Marketing Promise Into a Real Streaming Product

DIRECTV had already bought national ad spots promising "Everywhere" access — but the actual product was still half-baked. I was brought in as Product Manager to turn that promise into something subscribers could actually use: a true cross-platform streaming experience that worked across web, mobile, and connected devices, built from a partially-assembled stack with a very public deadline.

[Schedule a Call](#)[Download CV](#)**5M+**

DOWNLOADS AT LAUNCH

Year 1 across all platforms

5

DEVICE FAMILIES

Web · iOS · Android · Roku · Apple TV

1st

NATIONAL STREAMING PLATFORM

20M+ subscribers · 30+ teams aligned

QUICK STATS**5M+**

YEAR-1 DOWNLOADS

400+

TV NETWORKS INTEGRATED

Top Press

HR · ENGADGET · MIT TR

Foundation

FOR LATER DTV STREAMING

PROBLEM**The Launch Reality**

- Marketing promised "Watch Anywhere" before engineering was ready.
- 30+ teams were operating on disconnected roadmaps and UX assumptions.
- Netflix and HBO had reset customer expectations for cross-device parity.

[VIEW DETAILS +](#)**EXECUTION****What I Drove**

- Unified product flows across web, mobile, and connected TV surfaces.
- One identity + entitlement model for sign-in once, stream everywhere.
- Single launch playbook and governance model for 30+ teams.

[VIEW DETAILS +](#)

The Challenge

**CORE TENSION**

Simple for subscribers, complex for everyone building it: Before Everywhere, DIRECTV was still

dabble with a clunky VOD experience, but there was no sense that content followed you from screen to screen. Meanwhile, Netflix and HBO were training customers to expect exactly that, while marketing had already launched a national “Watch Anywhere” campaign before the product was ready. DIRECTV leadership needed a product that felt effortless to use even though rights, device rules, and entitlement logic behind the scenes were extraordinarily messy, and closing that gap was the central challenge I had to lead through.

NEEDS

What DIRECTV Needed

Ship the already-promised “Watch Anywhere” experience quickly enough to reduce churn while meeting rights and DRM constraints.

RISK

The Stakes

If 30+ teams couldn’t align before Netflix/HBO expectations hardened, DIRECTV risked a visible launch miss and brand damage.

Technical Blockers

Fragmented Identity & Entitlements

No shared auth model across platforms, so sign-in and access rules felt bolted-on and brittle.

Disconnected Live + VOD Catalogs

Users could stream, but discovery was incoherent because catalogs and search logic were split.

No Shared UX Pattern Layer

Six device surfaces were reinventing the same flows independently, increasing delivery risk and rework.

Organizational Blockers

30+ Teams, No Single Product Owner

Programming, devices, marketing, identity, and platform teams optimized locally, not as one product.

Marketing Timeline Outran Engineering

“Watch Anywhere” was already public, creating hard deadline pressure before technical alignment existed.

Roadmap + Design Governance Conflict

Design and engineering priorities repeatedly collided, slowing decisions and destabilizing execution.

What I Owned

ROLE SCOPE SNAPSHOT

Product Manager

June 2012 – June 2013

Cross-platform streaming launch orchestration across product, platform, identity, and device teams.

30+

TEAMS ALIGNED

6

SURFACES /
DEVICES

12 Mo

DELIVERY WINDOW

PLATFORM COVERAGE

Web iOS Android Roku Fire TV
Apple TV

OWNERSHIP

Product System Ownership

01 Cross-Device Product Model

Owned web, iOS, Android, Roku, Fire TV, and Apple TV as one product system from the same PRD spine.

02 Unified Experience Layer

Connected navigation, catalog, search, and playback into one consistent cross-platform flow.

03 Native but Consistent UX

Standardized patterns so each surface felt native without breaking overall product parity.

DELIVERY

Platform Governance & Delivery

01 Identity + Entitlement Architecture

Defined one sign-in path, entitlement visibility, and fewer dead-ends across devices and packages.

02 30+ Team Release Alignment

Ran a shared PRD and launch playbook across platform, identity, device, and marketing teams.

03 Decision Governance That Scaled

Set ownership and readiness criteria that accelerated trade-offs and seeded future streaming launches.

LAUNCH FEEDBACK

"Wow! That was explosive!" — Shayde Christian, Program Manager, DIRECTV

The Solution

SOLUTION ARCHITECTURE

TV That Follows You

One shared platform model across identity, catalog, and UX

SHARED IDENTITY

SSO + Entitlements

Credentials, package access, device limits



Web



iOS



Android



Web



Fire TV



Apple TV

Live + VOD in One Model
Search, browse, and discovery stay coherent

SHARED UX PATTERNS
One Product, Not 6 Experiments
Browse, player, and nav parity across surfaces

SHARED PLATFORM LAYER

DIRECTV Everywhere Product Model

Auth Entitlements Catalog Search Playback DRM

Ship once as a product system; adapt per surface without rebuilding the experience from scratch.

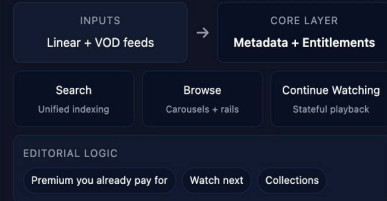
Cross-Platform Apps & UX

- Six surfaces — one PRD-driven product model, not six separate projects
- Browse, search, and playback patterns aligned across web and every connected device
- Updates to UI/UX could roll out consistently across all platforms
- Content and reach prioritized over UI perfection — right call, right outcome

Identity, Entitlements & DRM

- Sign in once — package recognized, watchable content surfaced immediately
- DRM and rights rules integrated without making subscribers fight the system
- Device limits and token management handled transparently in the background
- Successful play starts up; dead-ends and call-center contacts down

SHARED CATALOG MODEL



LAUNCH PLAYBOOK

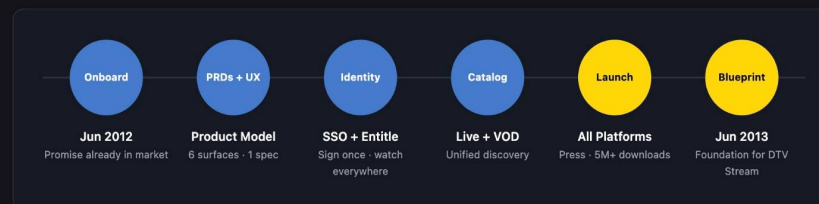
- 1 Ownership map**
Who owns APIs, UX, device QA, content ops, and cutover decisions
- 2 Definition of ready**
Catalog, auth, rights, and playback checks before launch train moves
- 3 Trade-off protocol**
How to cut scope without breaking the shared product model
- 4 Cutover plan**
30+ teams operating on the same launch sequence and escalation path

Outcome: coherent search/discovery + repeatable launch governance that outlived the first release.

Linear + VOD catalogs unified — "continue watching," "premium you already pay for" — governed by a release playbook keeping 30+ teams on the same cutover plan

- 👉 Common catalog and metadata model so search and discovery felt coherent across all surfaces
- 👉 Editorial collections and carousels built around real viewer behavior, not network org charts
- 👉 Release playbook: who owns what, what "ready" means, how trade-offs get made — outlived the launch

Delivery Timeline



● **Brought In — June 2012**

Marketing had already run national "Watch Anywhere" spots. Product was still half-built. I was brought in as PM with a founder's background in internet TV (ZEVO) — knowing how streaming should feel and what it takes to ship cross-device experiences under pressure.

● **PRDs, UX Model & Cross-Team Governance**

Wrote the PRDs and flows defining how you move from login to content to player across all six surfaces. Navigation, browse patterns, and the player model aligned from day one. Created the release playbook: who owns what, what "ready" means, and how trade-offs get made across 30+ teams.

● **Identity & Entitlement Model**

Partnered with identity teams to define the SSO model — DIRECTV credentials, tokens, device limits handled as one unified flow. Sign in once, package recognized, watchable content surfaced. DRM and rights rules integrated without making subscribers fight the system.

● **Catalog, Search & Discovery**

Connected linear and VOD catalogs into a single coherent experience. Search, carousels, and editorial collections built around real

catalog, made DTVE feel like TV.

Launch Across All Platforms

Web, iOS, Android, Roku, Fire TV, and Apple TV all shipped. 5M+ downloads in Year 1. The Hollywood Reporter, Engadget, MIT Technology Review, and Yahoo News covered the launch as a milestone in TV's shift to streaming — one of the first true "TV Everywhere" products from a major satellite provider.

Blueprint for Future Streaming — June 2013

The DTVE architecture — shared identity, unified catalog, cross-device UX patterns, release playbook — became the foundation for DIRECTV's later streaming-only offerings. The patterns we established before "streaming wars" was a headline are what everyone else now takes for granted.

Results

5M+

DOWNLOADS IN YEAR 1
Across all device families

5

DEVICE FAMILIES SHIPPED
Web · iOS · Android · Roku · CTV

Foundation

FOR DIRECTV STREAM
Architecture still in use today

Streaming Experience Shift

DIRECTV's first true cross-platform streaming product — shipped before "streaming wars" was even a headline.

BEFORE

Tethered to the Set-Top Box

- Clunky VOD experience and limited portability
- No true mobile streaming expectation met
- No unified login/entitlement experience
- 30+ teams working without one product model



AFTER

TV That Follows You

- Cross-device streaming across 5 device families
- Unified SSO and entitlement-aware access
- Live + VOD in one coherent product experience
- Launch traction proved demand at scale

5M+

DOWNLOADS IN YEAR 1

5

DEVICE FAMILIES SHIPPED

Foundation

FOR DIRECTV STREAM

Before DTVE

- Subscribers tethered to one TV — no true cross-device streaming, just limited VOD on PC
- "Watch Anywhere" marketing promise out ahead of reality — risking trust and call-center overload
- Each device team with its own roadmap and UX assumptions — no single cross-platform product view
- Auth and entitlements opaque — multiple steps, felt bolted-on, dead-ends common

After DTVE

- Single product spanning web and connected devices — millions of downloads in Y1 validating the strategy
- Unified SSO and entitlement model — clear what you can watch, successful play starts up
- Cross-device UX parity — UI updates rollout consistently across all platforms
- DTVE architecture became the foundation for DIRECTV's later streaming-only offerings

P Everywhere 60 I DIRECTV Full HD,1920x1080

Watch later Share



The Real Value: DIRECTV looked and behaved like a modern streaming company at a time when most pay-TV

providers were still treating apps as side projects. The patterns we established — authenticated streaming tied to pay-TV subscriptions, cross-device parity, shared entitlement model — are what everyone else now takes for granted.

Press & Recognition



Mar 11, 2012 · Solid Signal

Early coverage of DIRECTV Everywhere rollout and feature availability, documenting the launch context and initial consumer-facing positioning.

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Mar 21, 2012 · Engadget

Tech press coverage highlighting DIRECTV Everywhere as an important TV Everywhere milestone with cross-device streaming implications.

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Apr 17, 2012 · MIT Technology Review

Coverage framing the launch as part of the industry's technology transition toward authenticated streaming and multi-platform access.

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Apr 26, 2012 · Solid Signal

Follow-on reporting covering rollout details and user-facing functionality as the platform expanded and matured post-launch.

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Feb 25, 2014 · Roku.com

Platform ecosystem coverage showing DIRECTV Everywhere's presence in streaming-device channels and continued product distribution expansion.

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Apr 26, 2014 · Yahoo News (Clipping)

News clipping capturing broader media pickup and mainstream visibility for DIRECTV's streaming and TV Everywhere strategy.

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Jun 9, 2014 · Solid Signal

Additional coverage tracking ongoing feature, device, and service evolution as DIRECTV Everywhere continued to scale.

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Dec 19, 2014 · The Hollywood Reporter

Entertainment trade coverage reflecting industry recognition of DIRECTV's streaming distribution strategy and content experience positioning.

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Dec 19, 2014 · Variety

Trade press coverage documenting DIRECTV Everywhere within the broader media and distribution shift toward streaming-first behavior.

[View Article](#)

Apr 12, 2015 · Hive

Later-stage coverage showing the durability of the DIRECTV Everywhere model and its influence on how TV providers approached streaming access.

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Let's Build Something Extraordinary

Available for product leadership, platform architecture, and transformation program roles. Based in San Antonio, open to remote.

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